

Jiwan Chung
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Google Scholar

Research Profile

Postdoctoral researcher in Artificial Intelligence at Yonsei University working on multimodal intelligence, with a focus on reasoning, grounding, and agentic behavior. My research combines model design with diagnostic evaluation to improve how multimodal systems reason over visual evidence and make decisions across steps. I am seeking Research Scientist opportunities starting in 2027, in multimodal models, model mechanisms, and agents.

Research Areas

- Multimodal reasoning
- Grounded interaction and vision-language alignment
- Evaluation and diagnosis of AI systems
- Robustness and interpretability of multimodal models

Education

2023-26	Ph.D. , Artificial Intelligence, Yonsei University <i>Advisor: Seon Joo Kim; GPA: 4.3 / 4.3</i>
2019-23	M.S. , Computer Engineering, Seoul National University <i>Advisor: Gunhee Kim; GPA: 3.75 / 4.3</i>
2014-18	B.Sc. , Computer Science and Philosophy, Yonsei University <i>Double Major; GPA: 3.84 / 4.30</i>

Research Experience

Sep. 2026 - Present	Yonsei University , CIP Lab Continuing research on multimodal intelligence, with a focus on reasoning, grounding, and agentic behavior.	Postdoctoral Researcher
May 2025 - Aug. 2025	Microsoft Research , AI Frontiers Conducted research on diagnosing multimodal reasoning capabilities in MLLMs (MathLens; NeurIPS 2026), with the collaboration later continuing into process-level evaluation of web agents (WebStep; 2026).	Research Intern
Mar. 2024 - Jul. 2024	LG AI Research , AML Conducted research on extending multimodal LLMs beyond language-only outputs, including embodied VLA, image generation, and mathematical reasoning (DIST2Loss; ICLR 2026).	Research Intern
Jul. 2023 - Jan. 2024	Naver Cloud , Foundational Research Contributed to HyperCLOVA X LLM development and conducted preliminary exploration on omnimodal language modeling.	Research Intern

Selected Research

- 2026 **Where Did It Go Wrong? Process-Level Evaluation of Web Agents with Semantic State Tracking**
COLM 2026.
Developed a controlled benchmark for diagnosing process-level failures in web agents, enabling fine-grained analysis of exploration, execution, and decision-making behaviors.
- 2026 **v1: Learning to Point Visual Tokens for Multimodal Grounded Reasoning**
COLM 2026.
Developed visual pointing mechanisms to improve grounded reasoning in multimodal LLMs, enhancing their ability to align visual evidence with multi-step reasoning.
- 2026 **Teaching Metric Distance to Discrete Autoregressive Language Models**
ICLR 2026.
Introduced a training objective that teaches discrete autoregressive language models to represent metric distance, improving their ability to capture spatial and relational structure for embodied AI applications.
- 2025 **Are Any-to-Any Models More Consistent Across Modality Transfers Than Specialists?**
ACL 2025.
Developed a benchmark for evaluating consistency across multimodal transfer pathways, enabling fine-grained diagnosis of cross-modal behavior in any-to-any multimodal LLMs.

Conference Papers

 [Google Scholar](#)

† → Equal contribution

- *Global Geometry Is Not Enough for Vision Representations*
Jiwan Chung & Seon Joo Kim
[ICML 2026](#)
- *Rethinking State Tracking in Recurrent Models Through Error Control Dynamics*
Jiwan Chung, Heechan Choi & Seon Joo Kim
[NeurIPS 2026](#)
- *Teaching Metric Distance to Discrete Autoregressive Language Models*
Jiwan Chung, Saejin Kim, Yongrae Jo, Jaewoo Park, Dongjun Min & Youngjae Yu
[ICLR 2026](#)
- *v1: Learning to Point Visual Tokens for Multimodal Grounded Reasoning*
Jiwan Chung†, Junhyeok Kim†, Siyeol Kim, Jaeyoung Lee, Min Soo Kim & Youngjae Yu
[COLM 2026](#)
- *What MLLMs Learn When They Learn Multimodal Reasoning*
Jiwan Chung, Neel Joshi, Pratyusha Sharma, Youngjae Yu & Vibhav Vineet
[NeurIPS 2026](#)

- Where Did It Go Wrong? Process-Level Evaluation of Web Agents with Semantic State Tracking*
 Jiwan Chung, JiHyuk Byun, Vibhav Vineet & Seon Joo Kim
[COLM 2026](#)
- Are Any-to-Any Models More Consistent Across Modality Transfers Than Specialists?*
 Jiwan Chung, Janghan Yoon, Junhyeong Park, Sangeyl Lee, Joowon Yang, Sooyeon Park & Youngjae Yu
[ACL 2025](#)
- MASS: Overcoming Language Bias in Image-Text Matching*
 Jiwan Chung, Seungwon Lim, Sangkyu Lee & Youngjae Yu
[AAAI 2025](#)
- Speaking Beyond Language: A Large-Scale Multimodal Dataset for Learning Nonverbal Cues from Video-Grounded Dialogues*
 Jiwan Chung[†], Youngmin Kim[†], Jisoo Kim, Sunghyun Lee, Sangkyu Lee, Junhyeok Kim, Cheoljong Yang & Youngjae Yu
[ACL 2025](#)
- Can visual language models resolve textual ambiguity with visual cues? Let visual puns tell you!*
 Jiwan Chung, Seungwon Lim, Jaehyun Jeon, Seungbeen Lee & Youngjae Yu
[EMNLP 2024](#)
- Selective Vision is the Challenge for Visual Reasoning: A Benchmark for Visual Argument Understanding*
 Jiwan Chung[†], Sungjae Lee[†], Minseo Kim, Seungju Han, Ashkan Yousefpour, Jack Hessel & Youngjae Yu
[EMNLP 2024](#)
- Towards Visual Text Design Transfer Across Languages*
 Jiwan Chung[†], Yejin Choi[†], Sumin Shim, Giyeong Oh & Youngjae Yu
[NeurIPS D&B 2024](#)
- Fusing pre-trained language models with multimodal prompts through reinforcement learning*
 Jiwan Chung[†], Youngjae Yu[†], Heeseung Yun, Jack Hessel, Jae Sung Park, Ximing Lu, Rowan Zellers, Prithviraj Ammanabrolu, Ronan Le Bras, Gunhee Kim & Yejin Choi
[CVPR 2023](#)
- Long Story Short: a Summarize-then-Search Method for Long Video Question Answering*
 Jiwan Chung & Youngjae Yu
[BMVC 2023](#)
- VLIS: Unimodal Language Models Guide Multimodal Language Generation*
 Jiwan Chung & Youngjae Yu
[EMNLP 2023](#)
- Acav100m: Automatic curation of large-scale datasets for audio-visual video representation learning*
 Jiwan Chung[†], Sangho Lee[†], Youngjae Yu, Gunhee Kim, Thomas Breuel, Gal Chechik & Yale Song
[ICCV 2021](#)

- . *Transitional adaptation of pretrained models for visual storytelling*
Jiwan Chung[†], Youngjae Yu[†], Heeseung Yun, Jongseok Kim & Gunhee Kim
[CVPR 2021](#)
- . *A11YN: Aligning LLMs for Accessible Web UI Code Generation*
 Janghan Yoon, Jaegwan Cho, Junhyeok Kim, **Jiwan Chung**, Jaehyun Jeon & Youngjae Yu
[COLM 2026](#)
- . *Explain with Visual Keypoints Like a Real Mentor! A Benchmark for Multimodal Solution Explanation*
 Jaewoo Park, Jungyang Park, Dongju Jang, **Jiwan Chung**, Byungwoo Yoo, Jaewoo Shin, Seon-joon Park, Taehyeong Kim & Youngjae Yu
[AAAI 2026](#)
- . *GuideDog: A Real-World Egocentric Multimodal Dataset for Blind and Low-Vision Accessibility-Aware Guidance*
 Junhyeok Kim, Jaewoo Park, Junhee Park, Sangeyl Lee, **Jiwan Chung**, Jisung Kim, Ji Hoon Joung & Youngjae Yu
[ACL 2026](#)
- . *Mixture of Layers: Dynamic Layer Routing for Visual Reasoning*
 Jeonghwan Kim[†], Sofia Stoica[†], **Jiwan Chung**, Ansel Blume, Hyeonjeong Ha, Zhenhailong Wang, Xin Luna Dong & Heng Ji
[NeurIPS 2026](#)
- . *CANVAS: Commonsense-Aware Navigation System for Intuitive Human-Robot Interaction*
 Suhwan Choi, Yongjun Cho, Minchan Kim, Jaeyoon Jung, Myunchul Joe, Yubeen Park, Minseo Kim, Sungwoong Kim, Sungjae Lee, Hwiseong Park, **Jiwan Chung** & Youngjae Yu
[ICRA 2025](#)
- . *Do LLMs Have Distinct and Consistent Personality? TRAIT: Personality Testset designed for LLMs with Psychometrics*
 Seungbeen Lee, Seungwon Lim, Seungju Han, Giyeong Oh, Hyungjoo Chae, **Jiwan Chung**, Minju Kim, Beong-woo Kwak, Yeonsoo Lee, Dongha Lee, Jinyoung Yeo & Youngjae Yu
[NAACL Findings 2025](#)
- . *EgoSpeak: Learning When to Speak for Egocentric Conversational Agents in the Wild*
 Junhyeok Kim, Min Soo Kim, **Jiwan Chung**, Jungbin Cho, Jisoo Kim, Sungwoong Kim, Gyeongbo Sim & Youngjae Yu
[NAACL Findings 2025](#)
- . *VAGUE: Visual Contexts Clarify Ambiguous Expressions*
 Heejeong Nam, Jinwoo Ahn, Keummin Ka, **Jiwan Chung** & Youngjae Yu
[ICCV 2025](#)
- . *VisEscape: A Benchmark for Evaluating Exploration-driven Decision-making in Virtual Escape Rooms*
 Seungwon Lim, Sungwoong Kim, Jihwan Yu, Sungjae Lee, **Jiwan Chung** & Youngjae Yu
[EMNLP 2025](#)

- *Language models as compilers: Simulating pseudocode execution improves algorithmic reasoning in language models*
Hyunjoo Chae, Yeonghyeon Kim, Seungone Kim, Kai Tzu-iunn Ong, Beong-woo Kwak, Moohyeon Kim, Seonghwan Kim, Taeyoon Kwon, **Jiwan Chung**, Youngjae Yu & Jinyoung Yeo
[EMNLP 2024](#)
- *Reading Books is Great, But Not if You Are Driving! Visually Grounded Reasoning about Defeasible Commonsense Norms*
Seungju Han, Junhyeok Kim, Jack Hessel, Liwei Jiang, **Jiwan Chung**, Yejin Son, Yejin Choi & Youngjae Yu
[EMNLP 2023](#)
- *Character grounding and re-identification in story of videos and text descriptions*
Youngjae Yu, Jongseok Kim, Heeseung Yun, **Jiwan Chung** & Gunhee Kim
[ECCV 2020](#)

Preprints

- **SEAL: Entangled White-box Watermarks on Low-Rank Adaptation**
Giyeong Oh, Saejin Kim, Woohyun Cho, Sangkyu Lee, **Jiwan Chung**, Dokyung Song & Youngjae Yu
[arXiv 2025](#)
- **HyperCLOVA X Technical Report**
Kang Min Yoo, Jaegeun Han, Sookyo In, Heewon Jeon, Jisu Jeong, Jaewook Kang, Hyunwook Kim, Kyung-Min Kim, Munhyong Kim, Sungju Kim, HyperCLOVA X Team
[arXiv 2024](#)

Awards & Honors

2025	AI Seoul Tech Graduate Scholarship
2020	DramaQA2020 Challenge (ECCV Workshop), 1st place
2019	LSMDC2019 Challenge (ICCV Workshop), 1st place

Academic Service

Reviewer

- NeurIPS, ICLR, ICML
- CVPR, ICCV
- ACL Rolling Review (ARR)
- COLM
- TPAMI, TMLR

Last updated: September 26, 2026